



2026

English — Grade 6

Specimen Paper 1 of 4

Time allowed: 1 hour 45 minutes

Total marks: 100

Index Number:

Name: _____

Class:

1. This paper contains **9 questions**.
2. Write your Index Number in the space provided above.
3. Answer **all** questions.
4. Write your answers clearly in the spaces provided.
5. You may not use red, green or black ink.

[illegible]

Question 1 — Sentence Matching (5 marks)

Match each sentence on the left with the most suitable sentence on the right. An example is given. There is **one extra sentence** on the right that you will not use.

Example: There is heavy traffic on the road. •

(i) The garden had not been watered for a week. •

(ii) We saw a family of monkeys in the trees. •

(iii) The fish were jumping out of the water. •

(iv) There was no litter on the beach. •

(v) The sun was very strong that day. •

• *We were stuck in a long queue.*

• **A.** The plants were wilting and turning yellow.

• **B.** We were deep inside the forest.

• **C.** Something had frightened them.

• **D.** People had cleaned it up earlier.

• **E.** We put on sunscreen and our hats.

• **F.** The river was overflowing its banks.

Write the correct letter in each box:

(i) (ii) (iii) (iv) (v)

Question 2 — Grammar (10 marks)

For each item, circle the letter which shows the correct answer.

Example: Sarah loves painting. She a picture every day.

A paints

B painted

C is painting

D will paint

1. Amir went to Port Louis. bought some new books.

A She

B He

C They

D It

2. My father us to the lagoon last Sunday.

A takes

B is taking

C has taken

D took

3. There is water left in the bottle. I need to fill it.

A many

B little

Circle the letter which shows the correct word to complete each sentence.

1. The nurse asked the patient to take his three times a day.
A food
B water
C medicine
D rest
2. The children were when they saw the dolphin leap out of the water.
A bored
B tired
C frightened
D amazed
3. My grandmother likes to herbs and vegetables in her garden.
A eat
B grow
C buy
D cook
4. She spoke very so that the entire audience could hear her.
A quietly
B sadly
C slowly
D loudly
5. The at the nature park explained how to protect coral reefs.
A mechanic
B plumber
C guide
D driver

Question 4A — Reading Comprehension: Informational Text (10 marks)

Read the text below, then complete the sentences that follow.

The Coral Reefs of Mauritius

The coral reefs of Mauritius are among the most remarkable natural treasures of the Indian Ocean. They form a ring of shallow, clear water around much of the island, creating sheltered lagoons that are perfect for swimming and snorkelling. The reefs are built by millions of tiny sea creatures called coral polyps, which build hard limestone structures over hundreds of years.

These reefs support an extraordinary variety of marine life. Hundreds of species of colourful fish dart through the coral branches, while sea turtles glide gracefully above the sandy seabed. Starfish, sea urchins, octopuses and moray eels all make their homes in the reef. Scientists have identified over one thousand species of plants and animals living in Mauritius's lagoons.

Unfortunately, coral reefs around the world are under serious threat. Rising ocean temperatures caused by climate change lead to a process called bleaching, in which coral turns white and eventually dies. Pollution from boats, fertilisers and untreated waste also damages the reef. Careless tourists who stand on coral or remove pieces as souvenirs cause damage that can take decades to recover.

The Mauritian government has established marine parks and strict rules to protect the reefs. Fishing is restricted in certain zones, and boats must anchor away from the coral. Environmental groups run clean-up campaigns and educate the public about reef conservation. Every Mauritian has a role to play in keeping these extraordinary ecosystems safe for future generations.

Original passage

Based on the text, complete the following. Write your answers on the lines provided.

Example: This text is about: the coral reefs of Mauritius

1. What coral reefs form around Mauritius: _____
2. What coral polyps build: _____
3. Number of species in Mauritius's lagoons: _____

4. What bleaching causes coral to do: _____
5. One cause of bleaching: _____
6. One way tourists damage the reef: _____
7. What the government has set up to protect reefs: _____
8. Where boats must anchor: _____
9. What environmental groups do: _____
10. Who has a role to play in reef conservation: _____

Question 4B — Reading Comprehension: Narrative (15 marks)

The Butterfly

Meera was a lively ten-year-old girl who loved spending Saturday mornings in her grandmother's garden. She enjoyed watering the plants, chasing butterflies and watching bees collect nectar from the flowers.

One bright morning, she spotted something unusual near the rose bushes. A beautiful butterfly with orange and black wings was lying very still on the ground. Meera crouched down carefully and saw that one of its delicate wings had become stuck to a dried leaf. The butterfly was struggling helplessly.

"Poor little thing," Meera murmured softly.

She fetched a thin twig from the garden and, very gently, pried the wing free without touching it. For a long moment, nothing happened. Then, slowly, the butterfly spread its wings. It trembled once, twice — and in a burst of colour, it rose into the air and circled above Meera's head before settling on a nearby flower.

"Grandma! Grandma!" Meera ran inside, calling excitedly. "I saved a butterfly!"

Her grandmother listened to the story and smiled warmly. "You have shown real kindness and patience," she said. "Those are the finest qualities a person can have."

That night, as she lay in bed, Meera made a decision. She would plant more flowers in the garden so that butterflies would always have a safe place to live. She felt a warm glow of happiness — she had made a small difference in the world, and that felt wonderful.

Original passage

1. Indicate whether each statement is True or False. Tick (✓) the correct box.

[3]

Statement	True	False
(i) Meera found the butterfly near the pond.	☐	☐
(ii) The butterfly's wing was stuck to a dried leaf.	☐	☐

Statement	True	False
(iii) Meera's grandmother was angry with her.	☐	☐

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

2. What time of day did Meera usually go to the garden? [1]

- A Sunday afternoons B Saturday mornings
C Every evening D On school days

3. How did Meera free the butterfly's wing? [1]

- A She pulled the leaf off B She poured water on it
C She used a thin twig gently D She cut the leaf with scissors

4. In paragraph 3, "murmured" means she spoke ... [1]

- A very loudly B very quietly
C angrily D quickly

5. Which word BEST describes Meera? [1]

- A selfish B impatient
C caring D careless

Answer the following questions based on the text.

6. Why was the butterfly lying still on the ground? [2]

7. How did Meera's grandmother show that she was pleased? Use evidence from the text. [2]

8. Name TWO things Meera enjoyed doing in her grandmother's garden. [2]

(i) _____

(ii) _____

9. What decision did Meera make at the end of the story? Why? [2]

Question 5 — Sentence Writing (10 marks)

Write sentences by:

- (i) **Removing the extra word:**
We went to the beach on at the weekend.

[1]

- (ii) **Adding the required capital letter and full stop:**
the children saw many colourful fish in the sea

[1]

- (iii) **Putting the adverb 'carefully' in the right place:**
She picked up the injured bird.

[1]

- (iv) **Putting the words in order to make a sentence:**
swam – slowly – under – the – turtle – bridge

[1]

- (v) **Transforming into its NEGATIVE form:**
The gardener cuts the grass every morning.

[2]

- (vi) **Transforming into its INTERROGATIVE form:**
Riya has finished her science project.

[2]

- (vii) **Writing ONE sentence using these words:**
lagoon – reef – swim

[2]

Question 6A — Cloze Test: Word Bank (5 marks)

Complete the text by choosing the correct word from the word bank. The first one has been done for you. There is **one extra word** you will not use.

Word Bank: beautiful • carefully • decided • disappeared • quickly • still • never

One afternoon, Lara found a beautiful turtle on the beach. The turtle was sitting very _____ in the sand and could not move. Lara _____ she must help it. She _____ picked it up and walked _____ to the water's edge. The little turtle _____ into the waves.

Question 6B — Cloze Test: Your Own Words (5 marks)

Complete the text by writing **one suitable word** in each blank space.

Lara watched happily as the turtle _____ into the ocean. She felt very _____ of herself. Her mother, who had been watching _____, called out to her. "Well done!" she said, giving Lara a _____ hug. That evening, Lara _____ about her adventure in her diary.

Question 7A — Error Correction (5 marks)

Correct the underlined mistakes. Write the correct word in the bracket. The first one has been done for you.

Last weekend, my family and I goed (**went**) to the nature reserve near our home.

The reserve was () full of beautiful birds and trees. I seed (

) a large butterfly and ran to take a photograph. My little sister

falled () on the path but was not hurt. We buyed ()

some fresh fruit from a stall on our way home.

Question 7B — Word Forms (5 marks)

Fill in each blank using the correct form of the word given in CAPITALS.

The coral reef is one of Mauritius's most _____ (REMARK) natural
formations. A team of _____ (SCIENCE) studies the reef each year.
Their work is _____ (EXTREME) important for the environment.
Without _____ (CONSERVE), many reef animals could be
_____ (DANGER).

Question 8A — Picture Story (6 marks)

Write **one sentence** for each picture to make a short story. Use the words given.

[Picture 1: A family walks onto a beach on a sunny day, smiling and excited]

last weekend – beach

[Picture 2: Children spot a small injured seabird lying on the sand and look worried]

suddenly – discovered

[Picture 3: A park ranger arrives and gently takes the bird; the children watch happily]

luckily – rescued

Question 8B — Sentence Linking (4 marks)

Use the word in brackets to link the two sentences. Make any necessary changes.

Example: Zara loves nature. She visits the park every week. (and) → Zara loves nature and she visits the park every week.

1. Riya loves nature. She visits the botanical garden every month. (**because**)

[1]

2. Mr Kumar is our science teacher. He knows a lot about coral reefs. (**who**)

[1]

3. The storm began. We were exploring the lagoon. (**while**)

[1]

4. The weather is cold and rainy. The children are staying indoors. (**so**)

[1]

Question 9 — Writing Task (10 marks)

You went for a walk in a forest near your home and found an injured animal.

Write a story of about **120 words** saying what happened that day.

The following may help you:

- Where were you going and who was with you?
- What animal did you find? What was wrong with it?
- How did you help it?
- How did you feel at the end?

Mark Scheme — Specimen Paper 1

These suggested answers are provided as a guide. Accept any reasonable answer that demonstrates clear understanding of the text. For open-ended writing, apply professional judgement.

Question 1 — Sentence Matching (5 marks, 1 mark each)

Item	Answer
(i)	A — The plants were wilting and turning yellow.
(ii)	B — We were deep inside the forest.
(iii)	C — Something had frightened them.
(iv)	D — People had cleaned it up earlier.
(v)	E — We put on sunscreen and our hats.
Extra (unused)	F — The river was overflowing its banks.

Question 2 — Grammar MCQ (10 marks, 1 mark each)

Q	Answer	Q	Answer
1	B — He	6	C — was watering
2	D — took	7	D — themselves
3	B — little	8	B — finished
4	C — greatest	9	B — whose
5	C — in	10	B — because

Question 3A — Word Definitions (5 marks, 1 mark each)

Item	Answer
(i)	Harbour
(ii)	Pilot
(iii)	Shell
(iv)	Forest
(v)	Biology

Question 3B — Vocabulary MCQ (5 marks, 1 mark each)

Q	Answer
1	C — medicine
2	D — amazed
3	B — grow
4	D — loudly

Q	Answer
5	C — guide

Question 4A — Informational Text (10 marks, 1 mark each)

Q	Answer
1	Sheltered lagoons / a ring of shallow clear water
2	Hard limestone structures
3	Over one thousand species
4	It turns white and dies / bleaches
5	Rising ocean temperatures caused by climate change
6	They stand on coral / remove pieces as souvenirs (either)
7	Marine parks and strict rules
8	Away from the coral
9	They run clean-up campaigns and educate the public
10	Every Mauritian

Question 4B — Narrative Comprehension (15 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks
1(i) T/F	False (it was near the rose bushes)	1
1(ii) T/F	True	1
1(iii) T/F	False (she smiled warmly and praised her)	1
2	B — Saturday mornings	1
3	C — She used a thin twig gently	1
4	B — very quietly	1
5	C — caring	1
6	Its wing was stuck to a dried leaf / it could not fly	2
7	She smiled warmly; she said Meera showed “real kindness and patience” (1 mark for each piece of evidence, up to 2)	2
8	Any two: watering the plants / chasing butterflies / watching bees collect nectar (1 each)	2
9	She decided to plant more flowers so butterflies would have a safe place to live. She wanted to make a difference. (1 mark decision + 1 mark reason)	2

Question 5 — Sentence Writing (10 marks)

Item	Acceptable Answer	Marks
(i)	We went to the beach on the weekend. (remove "at") OR We went to the beach at the weekend. (remove "on")	1
(ii)	The children saw many colourful fish in the sea.	1
(iii)	She carefully picked up the injured bird. / She picked up the injured bird carefully.	1
(iv)	The turtle swam slowly under the bridge.	1
(v)	The gardener does not cut the grass every morning.	2
(vi)	Has Riya finished her science project?	2
(vii)	Any grammatically correct sentence using all three words, e.g. "The dolphins swim through the reef in the lagoon."	2

Question 6A — Cloze: Word Bank (5 marks, 1 mark each)

Blank	Answer
1 (example done)	beautiful
2	still
3	decided
4	carefully
5	quickly
6	disappeared
Extra (unused)	never

Question 6B — Cloze: Own Words (5 marks, 1 mark each)

Blank	Acceptable Answers
1	swam / disappeared / plunged / went
2	proud / happy / pleased / glad
3	nearby / quietly / from a distance / close by
4	big / warm / tight / long
5	wrote / told / read / thought

Question 7A — Error Correction (5 marks, 1 mark each)

Error	Correction
goed (done)	went
was	were
seed	saw
fallled	fell
buyed	bought

Question 7B — Word Forms (5 marks, 1 mark each)

Root Word	Correct Form
REMARK	remarkable
SCIENCE	scientists
EXTREME	extremely
CONSERVE	conservation
DANGER	endangered

Question 8A — Picture Story (6 marks, 2 marks per sentence)

Picture	Sample Answer	Marks
1	Last weekend, our family went to the beach for the day.	2
2	Suddenly, we discovered a small injured seabird lying on the sand.	2
3	Luckily, a park ranger arrived and rescued the bird safely.	2

Award 1 mark for using the given words correctly + 1 mark for a grammatically correct and relevant sentence.

Question 8B — Sentence Linking (4 marks, 1 mark each)

Q	Acceptable Answer
1	Riya visits the botanical garden every month because she loves nature.
2	Mr Kumar, who is our science teacher, knows a lot about coral reefs.
3	While we were exploring the lagoon, the storm began.
4	The weather is cold and rainy, so the children are staying indoors.

Question 9 — Writing Task (10 marks)

Criterion	Marks
Content: addresses the prompt using the bullet-point guide	up to 4
Language: vocabulary, sentence variety, correct grammar and spelling	up to 4
Organisation: logical sequence, paragraphs, clear beginning, middle and end	up to 2

Sample answer: One Saturday morning, my cousin and I were walking through the forest near our village when we heard a strange sound coming from behind a bush. We looked and found a young bird lying on the ground. One of its wings was bent and it could not fly. I felt very sorry for it. We carefully placed it in a box lined with leaves. My aunt called the nature reserve, and a wildlife officer came within an hour. He examined the bird and said it would recover fully. We named it Sunny. As we drove home, I felt proud that we had helped a living creature in need.